



Notes

Jul 16, 2026

Balasubramanian / Philip

Invited Philip Samuelraj Balasubramanian GR

Attachments 📎 Balasubramanian / Philip

Meeting records 📄 Transcript

Summary

Discussion regarding project status and revenue potential led to the strategic decision to launch an AI consulting practice.

Current Project Status Review

Proposals for PHOPS and CRM phase 3 are under review, with feedback pending. Management of client expectations remains a priority as team transitions occur.

Market Opportunity and Positioning

Existing client relationships reveal high revenue potential through enterprise-ready solutions. Leadership decided to launch a dedicated AI consulting practice to differentiate services from abstract management firms.

Consulting Strategy and Growth

The new practice will leverage existing design and discovery engagements to offer actionable implementation plans. This strategy capitalizes on technical execution capabilities to provide unique value.

Decisions

Aligned

- **TechJS AI consulting practice** The team will establish an AI consulting practice within TechJS to provide pre-study and operational readiness services to clients.

We've **updated the Decisions section** using your feedback.

Let us know what you think: [Helpful](#) or [Not Helpful](#)

Next steps

- ☐ [Balasubramanian GR] Research AI Consultancies: Contact leadership connections to gather details on prior AI consulting engagements and reporting structures. Evaluate the methodologies used before AI implementation within their organizations.
- ☐ [Balasubramanian GR] Identify Potential Hires: Review personal network for individuals interested in professional opportunities within the AI consulting practice. Communicate potential candidates to the team.
- ☐ [The group] Schedule Follow up: Arrange a time to discuss the development and implementation strategy for the new AI consulting practice.

Details

- **Project Proposals Status:** Balasubramanian GR and Philip Samuelraj discussed the status of proposals for PHOPS and CRM phase 3. For PHOPS, they are currently addressing clarifying questions from the client. Regarding CRM phase 3, Balasubramanian GR is waiting on feedback from Liz and plans to send a gentle status update without pushing for an immediate response ([00:00:53](#)).

- **Project Handovers and Client Feedback:** Balasubramanian GR noted that next week will be the last day for a colleague, meaning the project will come under their purview. Philip Samuelraj highlighted the importance of using project case studies for future references and mentioned that they provided specific disclaimers during the initial timeline estimations to manage client expectations effectively ([00:01:57](#)).
- **Client Value and Revenue Potential:** Philip Samuelraj discussed a client relationship, noting the client currently pays around \$250,000 per year, but the application is critical, serving as the client's "nervous system". Given the potential impact of an outage on a \$400 million company, Philip Samuelraj emphasized the need for enterprise-ready solutions, suggesting the opportunity could be worth half a million dollars ([00:03:26](#)).
- **Project Scoping and Risk Management:** Philip Samuelraj and Balasubramanian GR discussed scoping out the new opportunity to ensure they understand the project requirements, aiming to leverage work already completed for CRM phase 3. Balasubramanian GR mentioned that Dharma had also discussed the importance of the ops AI project in a recent one-on-one meeting, noting that they must handle the client staff carefully to avoid internal friction ([00:05:08](#)).
- **AI Audit Strategy and Market Positioning:** Balasubramanian GR revisited the concept of performing an AI audit to identify system improvements and process opportunities ([00:06:27](#)). Philip Samuelraj noted that clients often approach them with specific workflows and proof of concepts, which they typically manage via a paid, six-week, \$60,000 discovery phase to define requirements and costs ([00:07:20](#)).
- **Value Proposition for AI Consulting:** Philip Samuelraj and Balasubramanian GR discussed aligning their services with three key goals: increasing revenue, improving margins through cost savings, and enhancing client experience. Philip Samuelraj suggested that instead of competing directly with large management consulting firms—which often charge high fees for abstract strategy—they can offer a specialized consulting practice that provides actionable, high-ROI, and low-cost implementation plans ([00:08:57](#)).
- **Pre-readiness and Consulting Services:** Philip Samuelraj proposed developing an AI consulting practice within TechJS, offering a "pre-readiness" service to map business processes in detail for approximately \$150,000 over

eight weeks ([00:11:37](#)). Balasubramanian GR agreed, noting that their Design and Discovery (DND) engagements are effectively quasi-consulting services that can be rebranded to help clients reimagine their systems for AI integration ([00:13:05](#)).

- **Competitive Differentiation:** Balasubramanian GR observed that while large firms provide similar studies, they charge significantly higher fees compared to the TechJS model. Philip Samuelraj emphasized that their advantage lies in having "skin in the game," as they not only advise clients on strategy but also possess the capability to execute and build the solutions, which differentiates them from pure strategy consultants ([00:14:50](#)).
- **Intelligence Gathering and Next Steps:** Balasubramanian GR and Philip Samuelraj discussed the next steps, including scheduling time to further develop the consulting practice strategy. Balasubramanian GR committed to leveraging their network of leaders in the industry to gather intelligence on existing AI consulting engagements and reports, aiming to report findings back to Philip Samuelraj in a few days ([00:17:09](#)).
- **Allotment Update:** Balasubramanian GR concluded by noting that they expect the project allotment to arrive around the first week of August and agreed to keep Philip Samuelraj updated on the progress ([00:18:12](#)).

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Transcript

Jul 16, 2026

Balasubramanian / Philip - Transcript

00:00:53

Philip Samuelraj: Hey Bala, good evening. How are you?

Balasubramanian GR: Good man. How are you?

Philip Samuelraj: Good, good, good. Everybody

Balasubramanian GR: Good. Like NSR is both the projects we have proposed and day before yesterday we proposed

Philip Samuelraj: good?

Balasubramanian GR: the plan for both PHOPS and for CRM phase 3. Um PHOPS back and forth they had a couple of questions so we're just clarifying them. CRM phase three she said Liz said she'll get back to us. I'm going to send the send her asma like a general reminder today in status like uh give a little nudge and ask her like you know what's that what did she think what what's her feedback and also otherwise good uh okay

Philip Samuelraj: proposals. First time she first time I worked on the

Balasubramanian GR: Okay.

Philip Samuelraj: proposal Philip we don't work at your pace so some more time

Balasubramanian GR: Okay. Okay. Then then I'll then I'll hold on that gentle reminder. I'll just send a daily status report but then I'm not going to push her

00:01:57

Philip Samuelraj: Hello.

Balasubramanian GR: because she was very specific and I'll get back to you.

Philip Samuelraj: Hello.

Balasubramanian GR: I'll get back to you. I said okay fine no problem. You get back to us. No problem. So yeah that's what going on.

Philip Samuelraj: I'm

Balasubramanian GR: So yeah, next week is his last day. So it's coming under me. So Darma was talking to me. So yeah, I'm just going through opsai context and trying to understand the project etc. So the work is over. So

Philip Samuelraj: I say uh just I want to give you my the leadership contract

Balasubramanian GR: yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: right it's going to be our we once we launch that that is going to be a phenomenal case study phenomenal Uh,

Balasubramanian GR: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: okay.

Balasubramanian GR: N uh no no when we when we were planning for this right when we were doing the timeline estimates we like put a very specific disclaimer that like

Philip Samuelraj: It's awesome that you know not started you can actually project you can take because and manage yeah uh they are a great customer great reference

00:03:26

Balasubramanian GR: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: talks to them and gives really good feedback as well.

Balasubramanian GR: One more

Philip Samuelraj: Okay. Half a million straight

Balasubramanian GR: straight away. Okay.

Philip Samuelraj: Okay.

Balasubramanian GR: How much they are paying right now?

Philip Samuelraj: 250 per year something like that

Balasubramanian GR: Wow. Okay.

Philip Samuelraj: procedurate and they have a very long-term

Balasubramanian GR: Okay.

Philip Samuelraj: relationship because that's their almost like their nervous system. All right. Center nervous system.

Balasubramanian GR: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: It runs their entire company. We cannot have like

Balasubramanian GR: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: I think a \$400 million company there half an hour across uh uh easily that's the outage will soon amount to millions of dollars.

Balasubramanian GR: Yeah. Yeah. Makes sense.

Philip Samuelraj: So yeah more than a million dollars in revenues on

Balasubramanian GR: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: stake. So application has to be like purely enterprise ready and so on. That's how it should be. If you're half a million a lot of the functionality and so on so on.

00:05:08

Philip Samuelraj: So we need to figure out how best to take that opportunity

Balasubramanian GR: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: and I want to actually put a couple of guys there start scoping it out start building it and so on that we understand say for example 70 80% of C3 already this 30% and so on. We'll do it or we have making the progress we will be able to do it. Let's help you reprod. Written proposal for

Balasubramanian GR: Yeah, I think Dharma also brought it up today like we had a one-on-one with Dharma today morning. I was just discussing when Dharma was

explaining me all this right like ops AI you will probably have to you'll have to take care and all. So he was telling me like seated like we are working in the background. So

Philip Samuelraj: Amanda people will get you

Balasubramanian GR: sure point

Philip Samuelraj: know they all lower level and they might actually get like hey we want you

Balasubramanian GR: agree

Philip Samuelraj: know or see the whole risk. Okay, that's very

Balasubramanian GR: got it got.

00:06:27

Balasubramanian GR: Uhhuh.

Philip Samuelraj: important.

Balasubramanian GR: So getting back to what we were discussing right like two weeks back we had that quick call I was thinking so like now so we we we we left it off at an audit stage we said like let's do a let's enter it uh stating that let's do a AI audit and see like how AI your systems are where in your process AI can help and all um then I went a little deeper like pretty much like all the big four and all your big companies are doing that only now they like pretty much they have

Philip Samuelraj: Come

Balasubramanian GR: employed a lot of people they are doing that.

Philip Samuelraj: on.

Balasubramanian GR: So what I was thinking is like when clients came and spoke to you like because they were a little apprehension apprehension to immediately uh start an AI project right without actually knowing like what they can do what needs to be done uh were they really thinking about the cost or like what was their what was the reason why they wanted to do a sort of a pre-study

00:07:20

Philip Samuelraj: No no no no see uh there

Balasubramanian GR: before uh application.

Philip Samuelraj: are majority buckets on the fall under two one is uh they come with notar my CEO coach is the same CEO coach for non-star

Balasubramanian GR: Huh?

Philip Samuelraj: Jerry So Jerry had uh told them you have these many people I think a

Balasubramanian GR: Huh?

Philip Samuelraj: can solve for all of this build an operational platform. So they went over and did some amount of pre-work and say this is our entire workflow. uh or when they came to us they actually gave us a deck. Rajes and the team showed up with here is a pre proof of concept of how they were floored like are

Balasubramanian GR: No,

Philip Samuelraj: amazing.

Balasubramanian GR: no, no.

Philip Samuelraj: This is a million dollar deal now every how do we structure it we'll do a discovery phase or six weeks \$60,000 discovery we'll capture all of that we'll get your and then give you the cost okay that's most of the areas where people come up with this is my problem only in the discovery phall Half million There's a but the

00:08:57

Balasubramanian GR: All right.

Philip Samuelraj: large portion also

Balasubramanian GR: Correct.

Philip Samuelraj: There are three things we need to tie. Even when people come back with idea, right? The three things we tie. increase something that increases revenue, something that increases margin by saving on costs,

Balasubramanian GR: Number

Philip Samuelraj: provides like a way improved client experience mostly. Number two,

Balasubramanian GR: two.

Philip Samuelraj: I'll save \$5 million per year. increase revenue in certain. Hey, hey, we need to bid more to win more deals uplift increase and this okay I went over I gave the art of the possible tech you know overview to all of the bolden seuite our board is asking why don't to go and engage with Mck

Balasubramanian GR: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: will sit with you. we will conduct you know all interviews we will identify Christos doesn't want to go with the the big the big the big three of

Balasubramanian GR: Not the big force, the big ones.

Philip Samuelraj: management consulting or the big four of uh the rest accounting or so because he knows that he is going to pay a huge price for just action he feels right that's we don't have an offering and saying this is give us \$100,000 we will work with your team for two months \$150,000 we will work with your team for two months or eight weeks from we will definitely identify all of this we will plot them by a 2x2 matrix across ROI and

00:11:37

Philip Samuelraj: cost and see what is the highest ROI lowest cost for we'll stack rank them and then we can come over and go over and deliver it. We don't have like a pure consulting and the consulting what I'm thinking

Balasubramanian GR: You got it.

Philip Samuelraj: of building Dean. I think he my I need to take care of my kids. My wife is the one who's having a full-time job. I'm in a consulting job. So that's okay. But I do believe we can build the AA consulting practice inside of techjs which is going to be

very very important. The first services like hey we will do all of this identify what are things The second part is identify the same which is slightly like

Balasubramanian GR: Yeah, I was going to say Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: discovery but I my entire business process and all others to be

Balasubramanian GR: Huh?

Philip Samuelraj: mapped to be done and so on that in itself as a service okay the pre readiness for AI

Balasubramanian GR: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: particular operations we will map everything to the tiniest detail about operations here is like uh uh it needs uh you know 8 weeks uh I'm just saying right it needs \$150,000 now they

00:13:05

Balasubramanian GR: Mhm.

Philip Samuelraj: many people will happily sign for that service because we don't have the strength behind it we have not even offered we can

Balasubramanian GR: Yeah. exact point the point actually you I was thinking that you said the exact same thing like DND that is pretty much a quasi consulting engagement only what we are doing we

Philip Samuelraj: I'm up.

Balasubramanian GR: studying their system current system how can we reimagine and how can we make it better how can we make it AI enabled or how can we make it how can we automate

Philip Samuelraj: Yeah.

Balasubramanian GR: pretty much we can just change a little bit of how we narrate it and how we present it. That can pretty much be as you said it's a it's a pre-study consulting engagement like definitely it's a good yeah we

Philip Samuelraj: Come on.

Balasubramanian GR: can we can definitely do

Philip Samuelraj: So that's the whole idea I had.

Balasubramanian GR: it.

Philip Samuelraj: You can set like hey this is how the tech consulting practice looks like we need to be able to sell right what are things how do we sell how do we position how do we sell cross study as well hey what do the other big guys what terminologies are they using how are they selling what are what are they seeing and how is the market reacting I can find out and say hey because from a client perspective perspective We can study and we can stand up just that

00:14:50

Philip Samuelraj: practice.

Balasubramanian GR: Got it. I think see what I what I went through is that right like all big fores are doing the same thing. So I my first initial thought was then what's the difference and that was my first thought then the point that you made answered that question actually like cost is the biggest

Philip Samuelraj: Come

Balasubramanian GR: factor if they if they if they go to Mckenzie for that same report for that same study Mckenzie

Philip Samuelraj: on.

Balasubramanian GR: is going to charge us four or five times that what we are going to charge them and the quality of work in my perspective that we can give that quality of work I'm

Philip Samuelraj: Exactly. See they will have a lot of polish. This is the understanding also with um uh a lot of CEOs. Okay. The same people have told me,

Balasubramanian GR: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: Philip, if I work with you, you will find me something valuable,

Balasubramanian GR: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: you will help me build it because you have skin in the game.

00:15:59

Philip Samuelraj: See, for example, maintenance CEO Stan, he is now joined in Harvard maintenance. He is an ex strategy and consultant.

Balasubramanian GR: Okay.

Philip Samuelraj: He also realizes also this even when he is an ex strategy

Balasubramanian GR: So other point right like the other point you pointed out right like we can build we can not only consult

Philip Samuelraj: consultant

Balasubramanian GR: we can go ahead and execute it also we can tell what to do we can tell how to do and we can do that also for you. So we can continue with that also but yeah uh that's a very uh sensible line to sensitive line to cross because There could be a perspective that hey like since because you are building it you'll come back and say that like you have to build it so that's a line that we need to tread very carefully but yes

Philip Samuelraj: Come on.

Balasubramanian GR: from purely from a consulting perspective yes we can the DND bundle I

Philip Samuelraj: Yes.

Balasubramanian GR: think we can definitely do that

Philip Samuelraj: we can set things up.

00:17:09

Balasubramanian GR: Um

Philip Samuelraj: Uh what even more right I think who are people in who can be part of part of that who do we need to hire? If you can think of all of those things,

Balasubramanian GR: see so what do you think was the next plan of action like let me report like if I can like report we'll see like next If we can find some time to discuss

Philip Samuelraj: actually find time to

Balasubramanian GR: uh we'll we'll we'll we'll we'll pick a time and we'll discuss it.

Philip Samuelraj: discuss.

Balasubramanian GR: Yeah. Give me like a couple of days time. I mean Monday college group let

Philip Samuelraj: Okay.

Balasubramanian GR: me ask around because there are a lot of people who are at a leadership level who are implementing AI in their I'll ask them what kind of consulting engagements they did with any consulting companies and what kind of reports that they got. What kind of studies have they did before they implemented certain AI capabilities in their organization. I'll check with them and get back to you.

00:18:12

Balasubramanian GR: I'll see like what can what are the intelligence I can gather and I'll let you know.

Philip Samuelraj: Super hiring in your network or so

Balasubramanian GR: Cool.

Philip Samuelraj: on who are interested.

Balasubramanian GR: Uh uh I'll let you know. I'll let you already But let me check again.

Philip Samuelraj: Uh,

Balasubramanian GR: Like I didn't put a very strong one. I'll talk to people and I'll let you know. Um yeah, I'll good. This is a good direction like last two weeks

Philip Samuelraj: okay.

Balasubramanian GR: like I wanted to like focus fully on that. So I want to like put my full attention on that and get that done. So uh once because like last one one day I was a little like so I thought like let me get back to this. So yeah sure I'll get back to you soon.

Philip Samuelraj: Okay,

Balasubramanian GR: And another

Philip Samuelraj: cool.

Balasubramanian GR: update so

Philip Samuelraj: Come on, man.

Balasubramanian GR: mostly in the month end August first week we can expect our allotment. So I'll keep you posted.

Philip Samuelraj: Lovely, lovely. Bala,

Balasubramanian GR: Sure.

Philip Samuelraj: congrats.

Balasubramanian GR: Ch.

Philip Samuelraj: Uh,

Balasubramanian GR: No.

Philip Samuelraj: take off and enjoy your time during that time.

Balasubramanian GR: Yeah. Yeah. Sure. Sure.

Philip Samuelraj: Okay.

Balasubramanian GR: I'll let you know.

Philip Samuelraj: Okay.

Balasubramanian GR: So, man,

Philip Samuelraj: Awesome.

Balasubramanian GR: see you. Take care. Bye.

Philip Samuelraj: Bye-bye.

Transcription ended after 00:19:39

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